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Holster with retention device and related methods

Abstract

A holster is for a firearm and may include a holster body having a proximal wall to be adjacent a user, a distal wall opposite the proximal wall and defining a cavity to receive the firearm, a first longitudinal side coupling the proximal wall and the distal wall, and a second longitudinal side opposite the first longitudinal side and coupling the proximal wall and the distal wall. The holster may include a first retention device having an anchor body coupled between the proximal wall and the distal wall at the second longitudinal side, a flexible arm extending from the anchor body and to press against the firearm when in the cavity, and an adjustable feature carried by the anchor body and configured to bias the flexible arm against the firearm.

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Background/Summary

RELATED APPLICATION (1) This application is a continuation-in-part of prior filed copending application Ser. No. 29/915,065 filed Oct. 25, 2023, the entire subject matter of which is incorporated herein by reference in its entirety.

TECHNICAL FIELD

(1) The present disclosure relates to the field of firearm accessories, and, more particularly, to a firearm holster and related methods.

BACKGROUND

(2) Firearms have been relevant to American culture since the American Revolution. Indeed, the right to bear firearms was included within the Bill of Rights during the formation of our Constitution. Over the last two centuries, the firearms industry has developed into several silos or specialties: law enforcement and military, sportsman and recreational, and self-defense. Each of these specialties has also developed a large and robust associated firearm accessory industry. Firearm accessories include a large number of accessory types, including holsters, optics, cleaning tools, magazines, and firearms safes, for example.

(3) The firearm holster is typically designed to offer protection to the handgun, secure its retention, and provide ready access to it. Indeed, the firearm holster is one of the more traditional accessories and dates back several centuries. The modern firearm holster industry is quite large and robust. In fact, there are many varying types of holster types, and each holster type has hundreds of available commercial options. For example, firearm holster types may include open-carry holsters, concealed-carry holsters, motor vehicle holsters, and under desk holsters, etc.

(4) In some approaches, a holster may include multiple retention features for retaining the firearm in place. These are known as level II holsters, and typically comprise a friction lock for the firearm and another active retention device, such as a hood for the slide.

SUMMARY

(5) Generally, a holster is for a firearm and may comprise a holster body comprising a proximal wall to be adjacent a user, and a distal wall opposite the proximal wall and defining a cavity therebetween to receive the firearm. The holster body may also include a first longitudinal side coupling the proximal wall and the distal wall, and a second longitudinal side opposite the first longitudinal side and also coupling the proximal wall and the distal wall. The holster may include a first retention device comprising an anchor body coupled between the proximal wall and the distal wall at the second longitudinal side, a flexible arm extending from the anchor body and to press against the firearm when in the cavity, and an adjustable feature carried by the anchor body and configured to bias the flexible arm against the firearm.

(6) In particular, the adjustable feature may comprise an elongate fastener extending through the anchor body and against the flexible arm. The elongate fastener may comprise a threaded shank to threadingly engage a threaded through passageway in the anchor body, and a head coupled to the threaded shank opposite the flexible arm. The anchor body may define first and second through passageways, and each of the proximal wall and the distal wall may comprise first and second openings aligned with the first and second through passageways. The first retention device may comprise first and second fasteners respectively extending through the first and second through passageways, and the first and second openings.

(7) Also, the flexible arm may comprise a first surface abutting the adjustable feature, and a second

surface opposite the first surface and abutting the firearm. The first surface may define a raised portion abutting the adjustable feature, and the second surface may define a flat portion abutting the firearm.

(8) In some embodiments, the holster may further comprise a second retention device carried by the holster body adjacent to a rear slide of the firearm. Each of the proximal wall and the distal wall may comprise third and fourth openings at the second longitudinal side, and the holster body may comprise third and fourth fasteners respectively extending through the third and fourth openings. The proximal wall and the distal wall may be integrally coupled at the first longitudinal side.

(9) Another aspect is directed to a method for making a holster for a firearm. The method may include forming a holster body comprising a proximal wall to be adjacent a user, and a distal wall opposite the proximal wall and defining a cavity therebetween to receive the firearm. The holster body may comprise a first longitudinal side coupling the proximal wall and the distal wall, and a second longitudinal side opposite the first longitudinal side and coupling the proximal wall and the distal wall. The method also may include coupling a first retention device to the holster body. The first retention device may comprise an anchor body coupled between the proximal wall and the distal wall at the second longitudinal side, a flexible arm extending from the anchor body and to press against the firearm when in the cavity, and an adjustable feature carried by the anchor body and configured to bias the flexible arm against the firearm.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) FIG. 1 is a perspective view of a holster with a firearm, according to a first example embodiment of the present disclosure.

(2) FIG. 2 is a right-side view (distal wall side) of the holster and firearm of FIG. 1.

(3) FIG. 3 is a left side view (proximal wall side) of the holster and firearm of FIG. 1.

(4) FIG. 4 is a cross-sectional view of the holster and firearm of FIG. 1 along line 4-4.

(5) FIG. 5 is an enlarged right-side view of the holster and firearm of FIG. 1 with the distal wall being transparent.

(6) FIG. 6 is a right-side view of a first retention device from the holster of FIG. 1.

(7) FIG. 7 is a right-side view of a first retention device from a holster, according to a second example embodiment of the present disclosure.

(8) FIG. 8 is a right-side view of a first retention device from a holster, according to a third example embodiment of the present disclosure.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(9) The present disclosure will now be described more fully hereinafter with reference to the accompanying drawings, in which several embodiments of the invention are shown. This present disclosure may, however, be embodied in many different forms and should not be construed as limited to the embodiments set forth herein. Rather, these embodiments are provided so that this disclosure will be thorough and complete, and will fully convey the scope of the present disclosure to those skilled in the art. Like numbers refer to like elements throughout, and base **100** reference numerals are used to indicate similar elements in alternative embodiments.

(10) Referring initially to FIGS. 1-5, a holster **100** for a firearm **101** according to the present disclosure is now described. The holster **100** illustratively includes a holster body **102** comprising a proximal wall **103** to be adjacent a user (i.e., a righthanded holster), and a distal wall **104** opposite the proximal wall and defining a cavity **105** therebetween to receive the firearm. It should be appreciated that the holster **100** may be configured as a lefthanded holster.

(11) The holster body **102** illustratively includes a first longitudinal side **106** coupling the proximal wall **103** and the distal wall **104**. In particular, for the illustrated embodiment, the proximal wall

103 and the distal wall **104** are integrally coupled at the first longitudinal side **106**. In the illustrated embodiment, the proximal wall **103** and the distal wall **104** are formed from a press mold process (i.e., to fit the given firearm **101**) of a sheet of rigid material, for example, a thermoplastic acrylic-polyvinyl chloride polymer such as Kydex, and then folded over to define a U-shaped channel **107** in the first longitudinal side **106**. In other embodiments, the proximal wall **103** and the distal wall **104** are integral formed via an injection molding process, thereby removing the U-shaped channel **107**. Also, as will be appreciated, the illustrated firearm **101** is merely exemplary, and the teachings of the present disclosure may be applied to any firearm type.

(12) The holster body **102** illustratively includes a second longitudinal side **110** opposite the first longitudinal side **106** and coupling the proximal wall **103** and the distal wall **104**. Each of the proximal wall **103** and the distal wall **104** illustratively includes a first opening **111a**, a second opening **111b**, a third opening **111c**, and a fourth opening **111d** at the second longitudinal side **110**. The second longitudinal side **110** illustratively comprises a trigger guard portion **112** to receive a trigger guard of the firearm **101**.

(13) The holster **100** illustratively comprises a first retention device **113** comprising an anchor body **114** coupled between the proximal wall **103** and the distal wall **104** at the second longitudinal side **110**. In particular, the anchor body **114** defines first and second through passageways **115a-115b** aligned with the first and second openings **111a-111b** of each of the proximal wall **103** and the distal wall **104**.

(14) The first retention device **113** illustratively comprises first and second fasteners **116a-116b** (e.g., threaded holster screws having a threaded fastener and a reversed threaded flanged base) respectively extending through the first and second through passageways **115a-115b** and the first and second openings **111a-111b**. The holster body **102** illustratively includes third and fourth fasteners **116c-116d** (e.g., threaded holster screws having a threaded fastener and a reversed threaded flanged base or interfacing grommets) respectively extending through the third and fourth openings **111c-111d** of each of the proximal wall **103** and the distal wall **104** to couple respective ends together and define the second longitudinal side **110**.

(15) Referring now additionally to FIG. **6**, the anchor body **114** illustratively includes a first body surface **117** facing outward and being substantially flat, a second body surface **120** facing inward towards the firearm **101**, and a threaded through passageway **121** extending between the first body surface and the second body surface. The second body surface **120** illustratively includes first and second raised curved surfaces **118a-118b** flanking the threaded through passageway **121**, and a recessed surface **122** between the first and second raised curved surfaces. The threaded through passageway **121** opens up at the recessed surface **122**.

(16) The first retention device **113** illustratively comprises a flexible arm **123** extending from the anchor body **114** and to press against the firearm **101** when in the cavity **105**, and an adjustable feature **124** carried by the anchor body and configured to bias the flexible arm against the firearm. The flexible arm **123** illustratively turns back on itself (i.e., a substantially 180° turn) and comprises a proximal portion **125** being flat, a medial portion **126** extending from the proximal portion, and a distal portion **127** extending from the medial portion and curving inwardly and in tandem with curved surfaces of the anchor body **114**. Also, the medial portion **126** illustratively includes a first arm surface **130** abutting the adjustable feature **124**, and a second arm surface **131** opposite the first surface and abutting the firearm **101**. The first arm surface **130** defines a raised portion abutting the adjustable feature **124** and being received by the recessed surface **122**. The second arm surface **131** defines a flat portion abutting the firearm **101**.

(17) In the illustrated embodiment, the adjustable feature **124** comprises an elongate fastener **132** extending through the anchor body **114** and against the flexible arm **123**. The elongate fastener **132** comprises a threaded shank to threadingly engage the threaded through passageway **121** in the anchor body, and a head **133** coupled to the threaded shank opposite the flexible arm **123**. The head **133** illustratively comprises a hand screw interface for permitting easy adjustment by the user.

(18) As perhaps best seen in FIG. 5 with the dashed arrow and as will be appreciated, as the elongate fastener **132** is positioned longitudinally inward against the flexible arm **123**, the friction retention against the firearm **101** is increased. Conversely, as the elongate fastener **132** is positioned longitudinally outward and away from the flexible arm **123**, the friction retention against the firearm **101** is decreased.

(19) Further, the holster **100** illustratively includes a second retention device **134** carried by the holster body **102** adjacent to a rear slide of the firearm **101**. In the illustrated embodiment, the second retention device **134** comprises a pivoting hood **135** for retaining a rear slide portion of the firearm **101**, and a thumb lock release lever **136**. As perhaps best seen in FIG. 5, the proximal wall **103** and the distal wall **104** define an opening **137** for receiving the head **133** and permitting easy access for the user.

(20) Another aspect is directed to a method for making a holster **100** for a firearm **101**. The method includes forming a holster body **102** comprising a proximal wall **103** to be adjacent a user, a distal wall **104** opposite the proximal wall and defining a cavity **105** therebetween to receive the firearm, a first longitudinal side **106** coupling the proximal wall and the distal wall, and a second longitudinal side **110** opposite the first longitudinal side and coupling the proximal wall and the distal wall. The method also includes coupling a first retention device **113** to the holster body **102**. The first retention device **113** comprises an anchor body **114** coupled between the proximal wall **103** and the distal wall **104** at the second longitudinal side **110**, a flexible arm **123** extending from the anchor body and to press against the firearm **101** when in the cavity **105**, and an adjustable feature **124** carried by the anchor body and configured to bias the flexible arm against the firearm.

(21) Referring now additionally to FIG. 7, another embodiment of the retention device **213** is now described. In this embodiment of the retention device **213**, those elements already discussed above with respect to FIGS. 1-6 are incremented by **100** and most require no further discussion herein. This embodiment differs from the previous embodiment in that this retention device **213** illustratively includes the second arm surface **231** defining a ridged portion abutting the firearm (not shown) and comprising a plurality of ridges **240a-240h** to enhance a friction lock on the firearm.

(22) Referring now additionally to FIG. 8, another embodiment of the retention device **313** is now described. In this embodiment of the retention device **313**, those elements already discussed above with respect to FIGS. 1-6 are incremented by **200** and most require no further discussion herein. This embodiment differs from the previous embodiment in that this retention device **313** illustratively includes the second arm surface **331**, and a friction pad **340** coupled to the second arm surface **331** to enhance a friction lock on the firearm. In some embodiments, the friction pad **340** may comprise a high friction (i.e., sticky) material, such as rubber, with an adhesive backing.

(23) Many modifications and other embodiments of the present disclosure will come to the mind of one skilled in the art having the benefit of the teachings presented in the foregoing descriptions and the associated drawings. Therefore, it is understood that the present disclosure is not to be limited to the specific embodiments disclosed, and that modifications and embodiments are intended to be included within the scope of the appended claims.

Claims

1. A holster for a firearm, the holster comprising: a holster body comprising a proximal wall to be adjacent a user, a distal wall opposite the proximal wall and defining a cavity therebetween to receive the firearm, a first longitudinal side coupling the proximal wall and the distal wall, and a second longitudinal side opposite the first longitudinal side; and a first retention device comprising an anchor body coupled between the proximal wall and the distal wall at the second longitudinal side, a flexible arm extending from the anchor body and to press against the firearm when in the cavity, and an adjustable feature carried by the anchor body and configured to bias the flexible arm

against the firearm, the flexible arm comprising a first surface abutting the adjustable feature, and a second surface opposite the first surface and abutting the firearm, the first surface defining a raised portion abutting the adjustable feature, the second surface defining a flat portion abutting the firearm.

2. The holster of claim 1 wherein the adjustable feature comprises an elongate fastener extending through the anchor body and against the flexible arm.

3. The holster of claim 2 wherein the elongate fastener comprises a threaded shank to threadingly engage a threaded through passageway in the anchor body, and a head coupled to the threaded shank opposite the flexible arm.

4. The holster of claim 1 wherein the anchor body defines first and second through passageways; and wherein each of the proximal wall and the distal wall comprises first and second openings aligned with the first and second through passageways.

5. The holster of claim 4 wherein the first retention device comprises first and second fasteners respectively extending through the first and second through passageways, and the first and second openings.

6. The holster of claim 1 further comprising a second retention device carried by the holster body adjacent to a rear slide of the firearm.

7. The holster of claim 1 wherein each of the proximal wall and the distal wall comprises third and fourth openings at the second longitudinal side; and wherein the holster body comprises third and fourth fasteners respectively extending through the third and fourth openings.

8. The holster of claim 1 wherein the proximal wall and the distal wall are integrally coupled at the first longitudinal side.

9. A method for making a holster for a firearm, the method comprising: forming a holster body comprising a proximal wall to be adjacent a user, a distal wall opposite the proximal wall and defining a cavity therebetween to receive the firearm, a first longitudinal side coupling the proximal wall and the distal wall, and a second longitudinal side opposite the first longitudinal side; and coupling the proximal wall and the distal wall together using a first retention device, the first retention device comprising an anchor body coupled between the proximal wall and the distal wall at the second longitudinal side, a flexible arm extending from the anchor body and to press against the firearm when in the cavity, and an adjustable feature carried by the anchor body and configured to bias the flexible arm against the firearm, the flexible arm comprising a first surface abutting the adjustable feature, and a second surface opposite the first surface and abutting the firearm, the first surface defining a raised portion abutting the adjustable feature, the second surface defining a flat portion abutting the firearm.

10. The method of claim 9 wherein the adjustable feature comprises an elongate fastener extending through the anchor body and against the flexible arm.

11. The method of claim 10 wherein the elongate fastener comprises a threaded shank to threadingly engage a threaded through passageway in the anchor body, and a head coupled to the threaded shank opposite the flexible arm.

12. A holster for a firearm, the holster comprising: a holster body comprising a proximal wall to be adjacent a user, a distal wall opposite the proximal wall and defining a cavity therebetween to receive the firearm, a first longitudinal side coupling the proximal wall and the distal wall, a second longitudinal side opposite the first longitudinal side, each of the proximal wall and the distal wall comprising third and fourth openings at the second longitudinal side, and third and fourth fasteners respectively extending through the third and fourth openings; and a first retention device comprising an anchor body coupled between the proximal wall and the distal wall at the second longitudinal side, a flexible arm extending from the anchor body and to press against the firearm when in the cavity, and an adjustable feature carried by the anchor body and configured to bias the flexible arm against the firearm.

13. The holster of claim 12 wherein the adjustable feature comprises an elongate fastener extending

through the anchor body and against the flexible arm.

14. The holster of claim 13 wherein the elongate fastener comprises a threaded shank to threadingly engage a threaded through passageway in the anchor body, and a head coupled to the threaded shank opposite the flexible arm.

15. The holster of claim 12 wherein the anchor body defines first and second through passageways; and wherein each of the proximal wall and the distal wall comprises first and second openings aligned with the first and second through passageways.

16. The holster of claim 15 wherein the first retention device comprises first and second fasteners respectively extending through the first and second through passageways, and the first and second openings.

17. The holster of claim 12 further comprising a second retention device carried by the holster body adjacent to a rear slide of the firearm.

18. The holster of claim 12 wherein the proximal wall and the distal wall are integrally coupled at the first longitudinal side.
